

Domestic Travel Reimbursement Policy

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Owner	Finance Shared Services
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Currency	INR

This policy governs reimbursement of expenses incurred by employees on approved domestic business travel within India. It is the sole authority for what may be reimbursed under a domestic travel claim. Where this document does not price an expense, that expense is not payable automatically and must be decided by a person.

Each clause below is written to be read on its own. Clauses are addressed by their clause ID (for example [HTL-001](#)) and every reimbursement decision must cite the clause it was made under.

Clause types. [priced](#) — the clause sets an amount the system may pay against. [eligibility](#) — the clause permits or forbids, but sets no amount. [evidence](#) — the clause states what documentation is required. [control](#) — the clause defines a check. [authority](#) — the clause defines who may approve. [context](#) — background or definition; **a context clause is never authority to pay.**

1. Scope and general conditions

GEN-001 — Applicability

category: ALL | type: context | effective: 2026-04-01

This policy applies to all employees travelling on approved domestic business travel within India. Travel outside India is governed by the International Travel Policy and is out of scope for this document. An expense claimed under this policy that relates to foreign travel must not be assessed against these clauses.

GEN-002 — Currency

category: ALL | type: eligibility | effective: 2026-04-01

All amounts under this policy are stated and reimbursed in Indian Rupees (INR). A claim line denominated in any other currency is not reimbursable under this policy and must be raised as an exception for manual handling. Currency conversion is not performed automatically.

GEN-003 — Trip and claim structure

category: ALL | type: context | effective: 2026-04-01

Every claim must reference a single pre-approved trip. One claim is permitted per trip. A claim consists of one or more claim lines; each line carries exactly one expense category, one date or date range, one amount, and where required by [RCP-001](#), one receipt. The travel dates on the referenced trip determine which version of this policy applies to the claim.

GEN-004 — Definitions

category: ALL | type: context | effective: 2026-04-01

Travel day — each calendar day from the date of outbound departure to the date of return arrival, both inclusive. **Standard room** — the base accommodation category offered by a property, excluding suites, club floors, executive floors and any room sold as premium or luxury. **Sector** — one one-way journey between two airports, whether or not part of a return booking. **Claimed amount** — the amount the employee has entered on a claim line, before any assessment under this policy.

2. Expense categories

FLT-001 — Air travel

category: FLIGHT | type: priced | limit: INR 15000 per sector | effective: 2026-04-01

Domestic air travel is reimbursed in economy class only. Business class, first class and premium-economy fares are not reimbursable under this policy, irrespective of the fare paid or the reason for the upgrade, and a line identified as any of these must be rejected in full rather than reduced to the economy limit.

The maximum reimbursable amount is **INR 15,000 per one-way sector**, inclusive of base fare, statutory taxes and airline surcharges. Where the claimed amount for a sector exceeds this limit, the excess is not reimbursable and the limit is paid. Seat selection, priority boarding, lounge access and excess baggage charges are not reimbursable. A receipt is mandatory for every air travel line regardless of amount, and must satisfy RCP-001.

HTL-001 — Hotel accommodation

category: HOTEL | type: priced | limit: INR 8000 per night | effective: 2026-04-01

Hotel accommodation is reimbursed for standard rooms only, for nights falling within the approved trip dates. Suites, club floors, executive floors and rooms sold as premium or luxury are not reimbursable at the premium rate; where such a room is claimed, only the standard-room entitlement under this clause is payable.

The maximum reimbursable amount is **INR 8,000 per night, inclusive of all taxes**. Where the claimed tariff exceeds this limit, the excess is not reimbursable and the limit is paid for that night. Charges billed by the property that are not accommodation — including but not limited to minibar, laundry, spa, in-room dining, telephone and late check-out fees — are not reimbursable under this clause. A receipt is mandatory for every hotel line regardless of amount, and must satisfy RCP-001.

MEL-001 — Meals

category: MEALS | type: priced | limit: INR 1500 per travel day | effective: 2026-04-01

Meals taken by the travelling employee are reimbursed up to **INR 1,500 per travel day**, inclusive of taxes and service charges. The limit applies to the aggregate of all meal expenses for that day and is not transferable between days: an unused balance on one travel day does not increase the entitlement on another.

Alcoholic beverages are not reimbursable under any circumstance. Where an itemised receipt shows alcohol, the value of those items is deducted before the daily limit is applied. Meals for guests, clients or family members are not reimbursable under this clause and must be claimed, if at all, under the Business Entertainment Policy.

TXI-001 — Local transport

category: TAXI | type: priced | limit: INR 2000 per travel day | effective: 2026-04-01

Local transport at the destination — taxi, ride-hailing, auto-rickshaw, airport shuttle and metro — is reimbursed up to **INR 2,000 per travel day** in aggregate.

Journeys eligible under this clause are those between airport or station and hotel, between hotel and the office or client site, and between office and client site. Travel for sightseeing, leisure, personal errands or commuting between the employee's home and their base office is **not** reimbursable. Traffic fines, parking penalties and vehicle hire with a driver retained for personal use are not reimbursable.

INC-001 — Incidental and other expenses

category: INCIDENTAL | type: context | effective: 2026-04-01

Employees may incur incidental expenses in the ordinary course of business travel — for example internet access, printing, conference and event registration, portage, or business calls. Such expenses are recognised by this policy as capable of arising on business travel.

This clause sets no limit and does not itself authorise reimbursement. No amount may be paid against this clause. An expense that falls only under [INC-001](#) and under no priced clause must be routed for manual assessment under [EXC-001](#), where an approver may allow it at actuals against a documented business justification.

3. Evidence

RCP-001 — Receipt requirement

category: ALL | type: evidence | threshold: INR 500 | effective: 2026-04-01

Any claim line for an amount **above INR 500** requires a supporting receipt. A valid receipt carries all six of: a receipt or invoice number, the merchant name, the date of the transaction, the amount, the currency, and an indication of what was purchased sufficient to establish the expense category.

A line above the threshold with no receipt, or with a receipt missing any of the six required fields, is not reimbursable. Lines at or below INR 500 may be claimed without a receipt but must carry a description of the expense. This clause applies in addition to the receipt requirements stated in [FLT-001](#) and [HTL-001](#), which are mandatory at any amount.

EVD-001 — Legibility and consistency of evidence

category: ALL | type: evidence | effective: 2026-04-01

A receipt must be legible. Where the amount, date or merchant cannot be read with confidence from the document supplied, the line is treated as unsupported and is not assessed automatically.

Where the amount readable on the receipt differs from the amount entered on the claim line, the claim line is not reimbursed at the claimed amount. Such a line must be routed for manual assessment under [EXC-001](#); it must not be silently reduced to the receipt amount, because the discrepancy may indicate a claim error, a partial receipt or an altered document.

4. Controls

DUP-001 — Duplicate claims

category: ALL | type: control | lookback: 24 months | effective: 2026-04-01

An expense may be reimbursed once only. A claim line is treated as a duplicate where the combination of **employee, receipt or invoice number, merchant name, transaction date and amount** matches a line already submitted or settled within the preceding 24 months.

A line identified as a duplicate is not reimbursable and is rejected. Where the duplicate arises across two claims that are both open, the earlier claim prevails. Splitting a single expense across multiple lines or multiple claims in order to remain below a limit or threshold in this policy is a breach of this clause and of [GEN-003](#).

5. Approval authority

APR-001 — Approval authority by claim value

category: ALL | type: authority | effective: 2026-04-01

Authority to approve a domestic travel claim is determined by the total claimed value of the claim:

Claim total	Approver
Up to INR 25,000	Reporting Manager
INR 25,001 to INR 50,000	Senior Manager
Above INR 50,000	Finance Controller

The tier is set by the **total claimed amount**, not by the amount finally approved, so that a reduction made during assessment cannot move a claim into a lower tier of authority.

AGT-001 — Delegation to automated assessment

category: ALL | type: authority | limit: INR 25000 | effective: 2026-04-01

The automated assessment system holds the Reporting Manager's delegation under [APR-001](#) and no more. It may finalise a decision on a claim whose total claimed value is **at or below INR 25,000**, provided no manual review trigger under [EXC-001](#) is open.

A claim above that value is assessed in full by the system — lines priced, exclusions identified, evidence gathered and clauses cited — and is then presented to the approver named by [APR-001](#) for decision. The system does not approve, reject or settle such a claim on its own authority.

6. Exceptions

EXC-001 — Manual review

category: ALL | type: control | effective: 2026-04-01

A claim is routed to manual review, and must not be settled automatically, where any of the following is present:

1. The evidence for a line cannot be read with confidence, or the receipt amount disagrees with the claimed amount ([EVD-001](#)).
2. No clause of this policy prices the expense claimed on a line, or the policy version applicable to the travel dates cannot be determined ([GEN-003](#)).
3. A receipt required by [RCP-001](#), [FLT-001](#) or [HTL-001](#) is absent.
4. A line is a suspected duplicate that does not match the [DUP-001](#) key exactly. A line that does match the key exactly is rejected under [DUP-001](#) and does not require review.
5. The total claimed value of the claim exceeds the delegation in [AGT-001](#).
6. A system or service required to assess the claim is unavailable after its permitted retries.

Manual review is a valid outcome of assessment. An amount that cannot be assessed under this policy is **held** — neither approved nor rejected — and carried to the approver together with the reason it could not be decided.

EXC-002 — Deviation from this policy

category: ALL | type: authority | effective: 2026-04-01

A deviation from any limit or eligibility rule in this policy requires prior written approval from the Finance Controller, recorded against the trip before the claim is submitted. In the absence of such a record, the limits in this policy apply as written and may not be relaxed at the point of assessment.